



Bachelor thesis: Timeline, tips, and expectations

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*Adapted from slides by Michael Cochez



Timeline





Phase 1a - Getting started

- You already started reading some background papers

Week 1+2

- Read more related work and literature
 - Tip: write short summaries about them and how they relate to each other and to your work.
- Study existing implementations and frameworks
- By the end of week 2: you should have a clear understanding of the problem



Phase 1b - Getting started

Week 3+4

- Try to run some adaptations of existing implementations, mess around with them
- Create a research plan, including
 - Problem definition
 - Related work
 - Experimental setup
 - Datasets
 - Planned experiments
 - Expected outcomes
- First version ready end of week 3, feedback, final by the end of week 4



Phase 2 - Start Experimenting

Week 5+6

- Implement your first experiments
- Do not underestimate the amount of work on “boring tasks” like data cleaning



Phase 2b - Reconsider your experiments

Week 7+8

- Experiments are never perfect from the first attempt
- Plan your final experiments and perform them

- Write!



Phase 3 Wrapping up

Week 9+10

- Perform final experiments
- Write down your results
- Review
 - I make a pass through your draft thesis and provide feedback

Week 11-12

- Final writing parts
- Presentation time (poster)



Phase 3 timeline

Thesis draft submission	15-06
Feedback back to students	20-06
Presentation (likely posters)	TBD by dept.
Submission of final thesis version	30-06
Final grades inserted in the system	31-07



Practical



You have

- An overleaf repository - Do all your **writing** here! - in the same repository, with different documents.
 - Plan, keep track of your experiments
 - Related work
 - Thesis - start from the right template ([LNCS](#))
- A github repository
 - Keep **all** your **code**
 - Use branches when trying things out
- A google drive folder
 - Keep related papers
 - Keep **datasets** here
 - Keep meeting **reports and notes** here
 - Create report before **each meeting** - that way we use the time effectively



Meeting tips

1. To have effective meetings, prepare in advance. You could use this [slides](#) template. Feel free to adapt the template as you see fit, I created it as a framework for thinking about the research process, covering the objective, the approach, the results, and the outlook of your periodic updates.
2. Make the report self-contained. This means, include links and snapshots in the report to avoid us looking for information during the meeting. Summarize your thoughts and findings in advance, prior to the meeting. This way we can use the meeting to discuss your updates and concerns.
3. Please ensure that you leave every meeting knowing what your next steps are. If this is not the case, let me know.



Dealing with challenges

1. When experiencing implementation challenges, you are expected to resolve these on your own. Graduating Bachelor's students are expected to have knowledge of system paths, functions, general debugging techniques, etc.
2. When experiencing challenges with low model performance, reproducibility, parameter choices, etc. - consult literature and recent blogs. Most papers that use LLMs have extensive Appendix sections that detail the specific parameter choices, prompts, etc. There are great blogs and tutorials on Medium, TowardsDataScience, HuggingFace, etc. to help with these. Please try to be resourceful, and to solve implementation challenges on your own first.
3. If you do feel stuck (for example, you do not see a path forward despite working on something for a while), let me know and we will discuss.
4. In any case, list the challenges that you are facing in the report. Also note challenges that you managed to solve, it may be relevant for the thesis report.



You may need

- A DAS5 account
 - Large RAM use
 - Specific GPU configurations
 - Usage of graph databases
- Specific accounts
 - Measuring performance of algorithms



Communication

- Slack (channel if >1 student)
- Send links to things on google docs, overleaf, etc. rather than documents
- You can use #general for general questions
- Meetings will be at the VU (unless one of us is traveling)